Carlos Santisteban

Portfolio: carlos.santisteban.site

Frontend / Product Engineer

React, TypeScript, practical AI-assisted workflows, and AI-enabled web apps

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Berlin, Germany | Mexican & Spanish EU citizen

SUMMARY

Frontend/product engineer with 8+ years of experience building user-facing web applications, strongest in React, TypeScript, JavaScript, product UI, and large production codebases. Uses practical AI-assisted workflows for prototyping, debugging, architecture exploration, implementation, refactoring, and product polish. Has built selected web apps and practical AI-enabled features while keeping ownership of product direction, architecture choices, review, deployment, and final behavior.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Frontend & Architecture:

React, TypeScript, JavaScript, component architecture, Redux Toolkit, React Context, TanStack Query, Zustand, Apollo Client, complex product workflows, responsive UI, SSR, routing, monorepos, Material UI, styled-components

Data & Product Delivery:

GraphQL, REST APIs, Node.js, PostgreSQL, WebSockets, browser APIs, PWA/offline support, performance, technical SEO, Docker, GitHub Actions, CI/CD

Quality & Engineering Practices:

Unit, component, and end-to-end testing, debugging, code review, technical planning, mentoring, cross-functional collaboration, AI-assisted development

EXPERIENCE

Independent Web Development

Berlin | Apr 2025 - Present

Web apps, UX, and AI-assisted delivery workflows

Designed and built independent React/TypeScript web applications across polished UI, search/filter and comparison flows, realtime interactions, PWA/offline behavior, data pipelines, deployment automation, debugging, and iteration. Applied modern web tooling, full-stack delivery patterns, and AI-assisted development workflows while owning architecture decisions, product direction, and final behavior.

Lingoda

Berlin | Jun 2021 - Mar 2025

Software Engineer - Language learning platform

Built production frontend features for Lingoda, including practice exercises, quizzes, flashcards, and student-facing flows. Contributed to Lingobites, an interactive practice feature with AI-generated exercise content and human-in-the-loop quality review. Built the student-facing exercise UI, session flow, state management, progress tracking, gamification behavior, and integration of existing flashcards.

Quandoo

Berlin | Sep 2017 - Jan 2021

Software Engineer - Restaurant reservation platform

Built and improved the consumer restaurant booking site across search, discovery, reservation, promotional, SEO, and performance surfaces. Led investigation and planning for a major React Router migration, mapping dependencies, comparing options, documenting tradeoffs, and helping preserve custom SSR and styled-components behavior while unblocking React/library upgrades. Also worked on metadata, canonicals, internal linking, indexability, availability filters, and time-to-first-paint/time-to-interactive improvements.

Market Logic Software

Berlin | Mar 2016 - Jul 2016

Web Developer - Data visualization UIs

Built data-heavy UI components, interactive graphs, and dynamic widgets with React and D3.js for an enterprise market intelligence platform. Worked on interfaces that translated research and insight data into usable visual product surfaces.

EDUCATION

Bachelor of IT Engineering - Tecnologico de Monterrey, Mexico

Aug 2012 - May 2017

Coursework: object-oriented programming, data structures, databases, networks, servers, operating systems, IT security, and cloud computing. DAAD scholarship exchange semester in Informatics at Hochschule Furtwangen, Germany.